

Marker Tracker

User Manual

A REAPER script — an on-screen counter of passed markers and regions

Emelowsky Plugins

Document version 2.0 (Marker Tracker 1.0.1)

Contents

(If the table below looks empty, right-click it and choose “Update Field” → “Update entire table”.)

1. Introduction 3
2. Requirements and installation 3
2.1 What you need 3
2.2 Installing with ReaPack (recommended) 4
2.3 Manual installation (from the shop package) 4
2.4 Toolbar button 4
3. Starting and closing 4
4. The counter 5
4.1 Empty project 5
4.2 Moving the counter 5
5. The right-click menu 5
5.1 Markers or regions 6
6. Position lock 7
6.1 Lock position (to the screen) 7
6.2 Lock position to REAPER window 7
7. The Options panel 7
8. The “What's new” window 10
9. Practical tips 11
10. Troubleshooting 11
11. Contact and support 12
11.1 Version history 12

1. Introduction

Marker Tracker is a small floating counter over your REAPER project. It shows **which marker the playhead has just passed** (e.g. “3 / 7”) and **what that marker is called** (e.g. “Chorus”). The counter has no background, frame or title bar — you only see the text, so it never covers your work.

The script exists to help you **find your way between markers and regions** and see them from a distance. Often you know which marker the playhead has passed, but you cannot see what that part of the song is — especially when the screen is far away: behind the drum kit, across the control room or at the other end of the desk. Marker Tracker shows the marker name in large, clear text wherever you place it, so one glance tells you which part of the song (or which take, scene or chapter) is playing right now — no hunting for flags on the ruler. The counter can also track **regions** instead of markers.

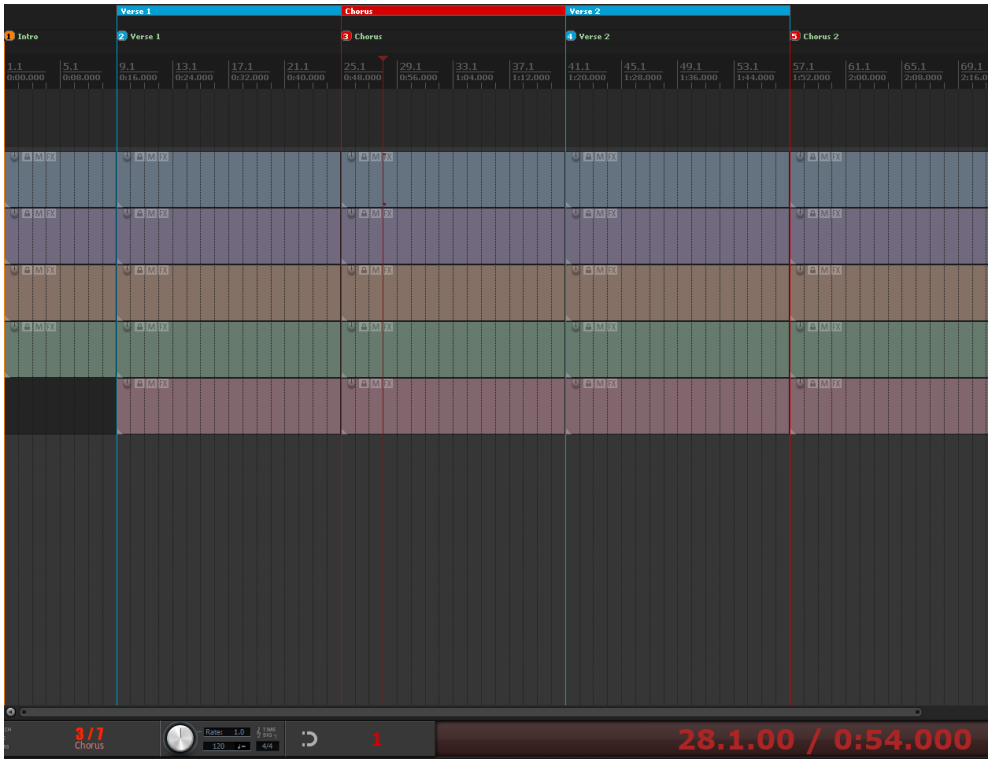


Fig. 1. Marker Tracker over a project: the counter “3 / 7” and the marker name “Chorus” (here in the spot the author chose — next to the transport).

Marker Tracker is **free** — no license, no activation and no limits. It is a single `.lua` file. This manual is your reference and describes every option. The script is still being developed — if something is missing or does not work, write to: emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com.

2. Requirements and installation

2.1 What you need

- **REAPER 7** (the file from the `Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)` folder) or **REAPER 6** (the separate “(REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)” package).
- **ReaImGui 0.10 or newer** — the extension that draws the script's windows. Install: Extensions → ReaPack → Browse packages…, search for “ReaImGui” → Install → Apply, then restart REAPER.
- **js_ReaScriptAPI** (optional, also from ReaPack) — more reliable “Always on top” and the lock to the REAPER window (section 6.2).

If ReaImGui is missing, the script shows a message at startup; the “Yes” button opens reapack.com with instructions for installing ReaPack.

2.2 Installing with ReaPack (recommended)

With ReaPack, updates arrive on their own (Extensions → ReaPack → Synchronize packages).

1. Extensions → ReaPack → **Import repositories…** and paste the address:

`https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Emelowsky/reapack/main/index.xml`

2. Extensions → ReaPack → **Browse packages…** → search for “Marker Tracker” → tick “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker” → Install → Apply.

Done — ReaPack adds the “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker” action to the Action List by itself.

> **Important:** ReaPack installs the script into a different folder than a manual install: `Scripts/Emelowsky/Marker Tracker/` (with an extra “Emelowsky” folder), not `Scripts/Marker Tracker/`. Pick one way to install — a manual copy and a ReaPack copy are two separate actions (they share the settings).

2.3 Manual installation (from the shop package)

1. In REAPER: Options → **Show REAPER resource path in explorer/finder**.
2. In the `Scripts` folder, create a subfolder `Marker Tracker`.
3. Copy `Emelowsky - Marker Tracker.lua` from the package's `Lua 5.4 (REAPER 7)` folder into it (REAPER 6: from the “(REAPER 6, Lua 5.3)” package).
4. Actions → **Show action list** → New action… → **Load ReaScript…** → pick the copied file. The action appears as “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker”.

> **Tip:** When you assign a keyboard shortcut, set the Scope to “Global + text fields” in the key dialog, not just “Global” — otherwise the shortcut will not work while the cursor is in a text field.

2.4 Toolbar button

The handiest way to launch Marker Tracker is a toolbar button — it lights up while the counter is on, and a second click closes it. The icon is in the shop package: `Emelowsky - Marker Tracker (toolbar icon).zip`.

1. Unzip it into REAPER's resource folder (Options → Show REAPER resource path…). The files go to `Data/toolbar_icons/` (three sizes: normal, 150% and 200%).
2. Right-click the toolbar → **Customize toolbar…** → Add… → pick the “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker” action.
3. Select the new button → **Icon…** → pick “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker” → OK → Save.

3. Starting and closing

Run the “Emelowsky - Marker Tracker” action (button, shortcut or Action List). The counter appears — on the first run in English, in a spot chosen by ReaImGui. Nothing else opens on its own.

- **Closing:** run the same action again (the toolbar button goes dark) or choose “Close Marker Tracker” in the right-click menu.
- **Language:** change it in Options (section 7.1) — the script speaks Polish, English, German, French and Spanish.
- All settings (look, position, mode) are remembered between runs.

4. The counter

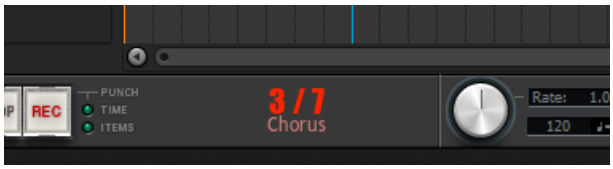


Fig. 2. The counter: top line — which marker the playhead has passed and how many there are; bottom line — the name of that marker.

The counter has two lines:

Line	What it shows
Top, e.g. **3 / 7**	The number of the last marker the playhead has passed and the total number of markers in the project. Before the first marker: “0 / 7”.
Bottom, e.g. **Chorus**	The name of that marker. A marker without a name: “(unnamed marker)”.

- During **playback and recording** the counter follows the playhead; when **stopped** — the edit cursor. Clicking on the timeline changes the counter right away.
- Adding, moving, deleting or renaming a marker — the counter shows the change immediately.
- When the name gets longer, “3 / 7” stays put and the name grows to both sides — nothing jumps.

4.1 Empty project

In a project without markers the counter shows “0” and a hint where the menu is — the counter itself has no buttons, so this is easy to forget.

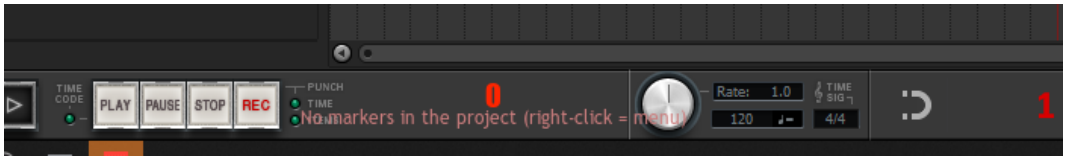


Fig. 3. A project without markers: “0” and the hint “No markers in the project (right-click = menu)”.

4.2 Moving the counter

Grab the counter with the **left mouse button** and drag it where you want it. The position is saved when you release the button. The counter does not flicker while moving and keeps “Always on top”. To avoid moving it by accident, lock its position (section 6).

5. The right-click menu

Right-click the counter. The menu has quick toggles — everything else is in Options.

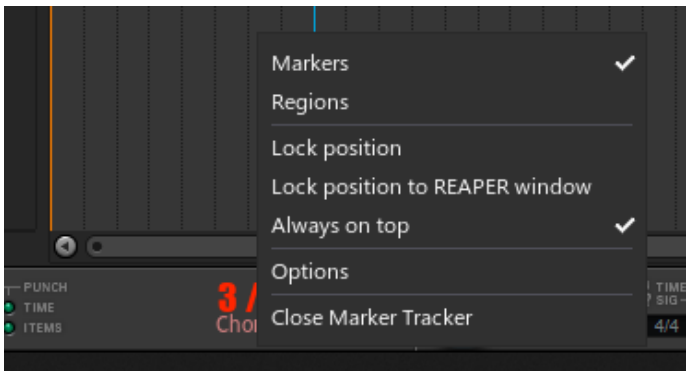


Fig. 4. The right-click menu on the counter.

Item	What it does
Markers / Regions	What the counter tracks (section 5.1). The current mode is ticked.
Lock position	The counter stays in the same place on the screen and cannot be moved (6.1).
Lock position to REAPER window	The counter moves together with the REAPER window (6.2).
Always on top	The counter always stays above other windows (on by default).
Options	Opens the Options window (section 7); a second click closes it.
Close Marker Tracker	Closes the counter (same as running the action again).

5.1 Markers or regions

In **Regions** mode the counter counts regions instead of markers: “2 / 3” means the playhead is in the second of three regions (or after it, before the third one starts), and the bottom line shows that region's name. A region without a name: “(unnamed region)”.

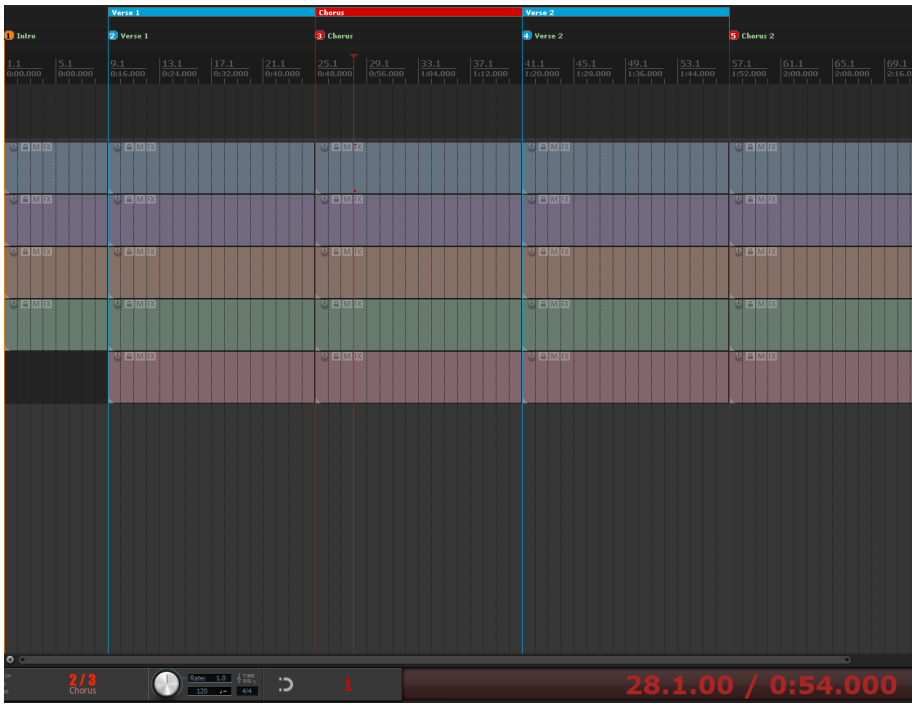


Fig. 5. “Regions” mode: the counter “2 / 3” and the region name “Chorus”.

6. Position lock

There are two locks. At most one is on at a time — turning one on turns the other off. With either lock the counter cannot be dragged; to move it, turn the lock off, move the counter and turn the lock back on.

6.1 Lock position (to the screen)

The counter stays in the same place on the screen, whatever happens to the REAPER window.

6.2 Lock position to REAPER window

The counter sticks to the REAPER window: move the window or resize it — the counter goes with it. The distance from the window's top-left corner **scales with the window size**: if you move REAPER from a Full HD screen to a wider one (e.g. 2560 px), the counter lands in the same place relative to the window, proportionally further from the left edge. While REAPER is **minimized** the counter hides and comes back with the window.

> **Note:** This lock needs the js_ReaScriptAPI extension. Without it the item is greyed out and shows the hint "Requires the js_ReaScriptAPI extension (ReaPack)."

7. The Options panel

Right-click the counter → **Options**. The Options window opens on the counter's screen and always fits on it. Move it by its title bar or any empty spot. Changes apply immediately and are saved automatically — there is no "Save" button. **Close** at the bottom (or Esc) closes the window and keeps your changes.

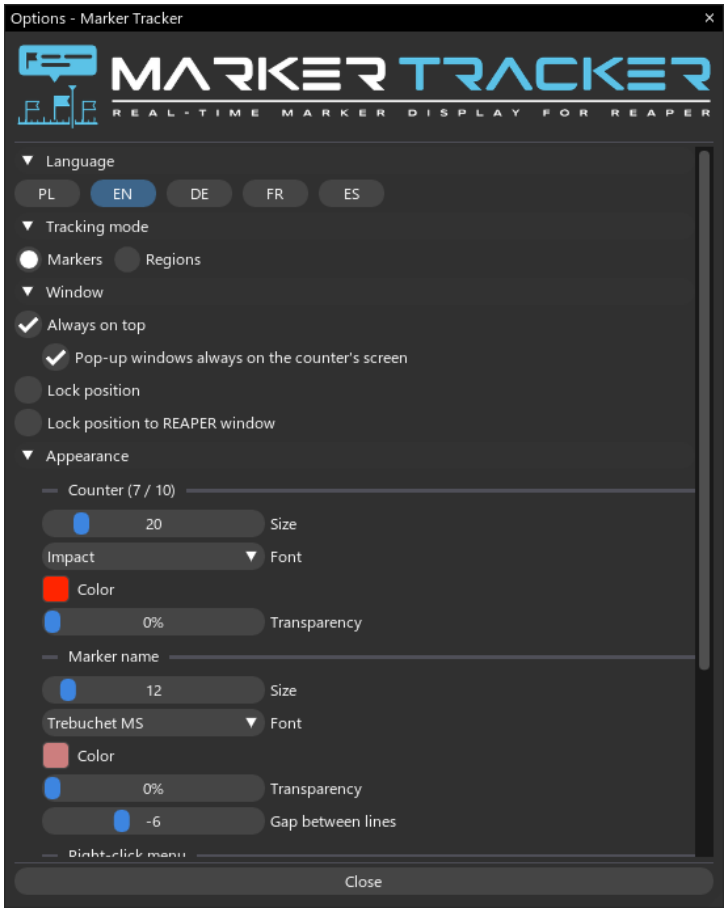


Fig. 6. Options: logo, Language, Tracking mode, Window and the start of Appearance.

Language

The **PL / EN / DE / FR / ES** buttons — the selected one is highlighted in blue. The change applies immediately in every window of the script.

Tracking mode

Markers or **Regions** — the same as in the right-click menu (section 5.1).

Window

Option	What it does
Always on top	The counter and the script's windows always stay above other windows (on by default).
Pop-up windows always on the counter's screen	Options and “What's new” open on the same monitor as the counter (on by default). After that they remember their position.
Lock position	Lock to the screen (6.1).
Lock position to REAPER window	Lock to the REAPER window (6.2).

Appearance

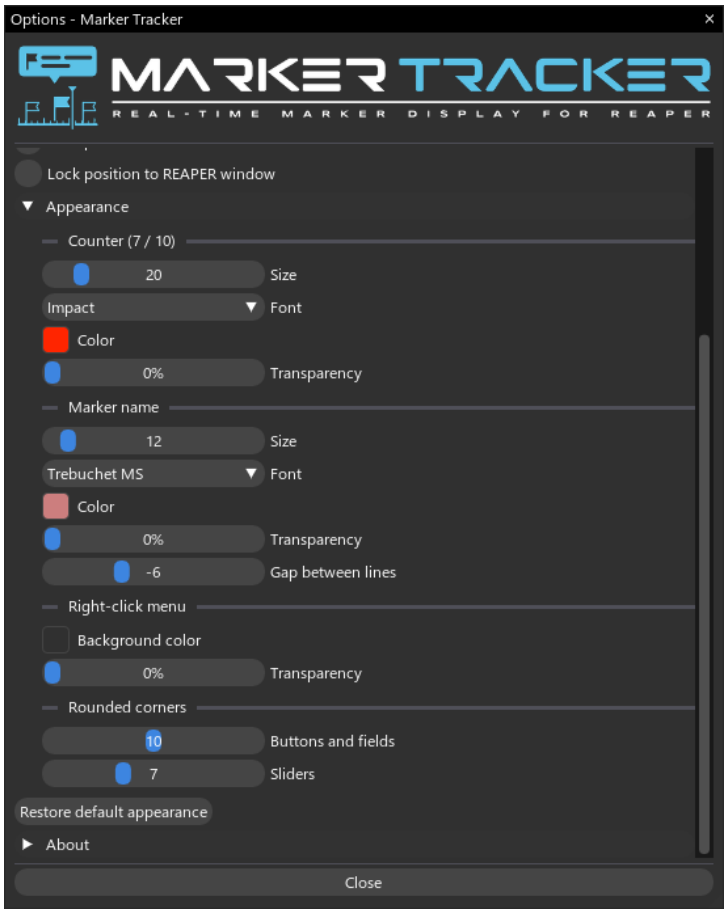


Fig. 7. The Appearance section: counter, marker name, right-click menu, rounded corners.

Group	Settings
Counter (7 / 10)	Size (10–80), Font, Color, Transparency (0–100%).
Marker name	Size, Font, Color, Transparency, Gap between lines (negative = lines closer together).

Right-click menu	Background color and Transparency of the right-click menu.
Rounded corners	Buttons and fields, Sliders (0–20 px) — like the whole Emelowsky Plugins family.
Restore default appearance	Goes back to the factory look (fonts, colors, sizes). The position lock, “Always on top” and the counter's position stay.

Fonts to choose from: Tahoma, Verdana, Segoe UI, Calibri, Arial, Trebuchet MS, Consolas, Arial Black, Impact. By default the counter uses a red Impact and the name uses Trebuchet MS.

Picking a color

Click a color square — a window with a full color picker opens (field, hue slider, RGB / HSV values and a #RRGGBB code). The color changes live. **OK** (or Enter) keeps the new color, **Cancel** (or Esc) brings back the color from before.

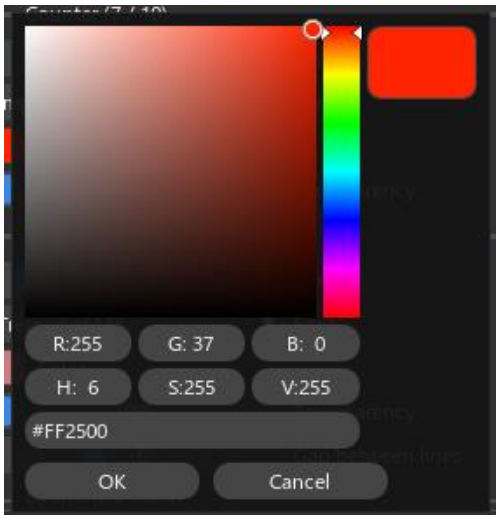


Fig. 8. The color picker with OK and Cancel.

About

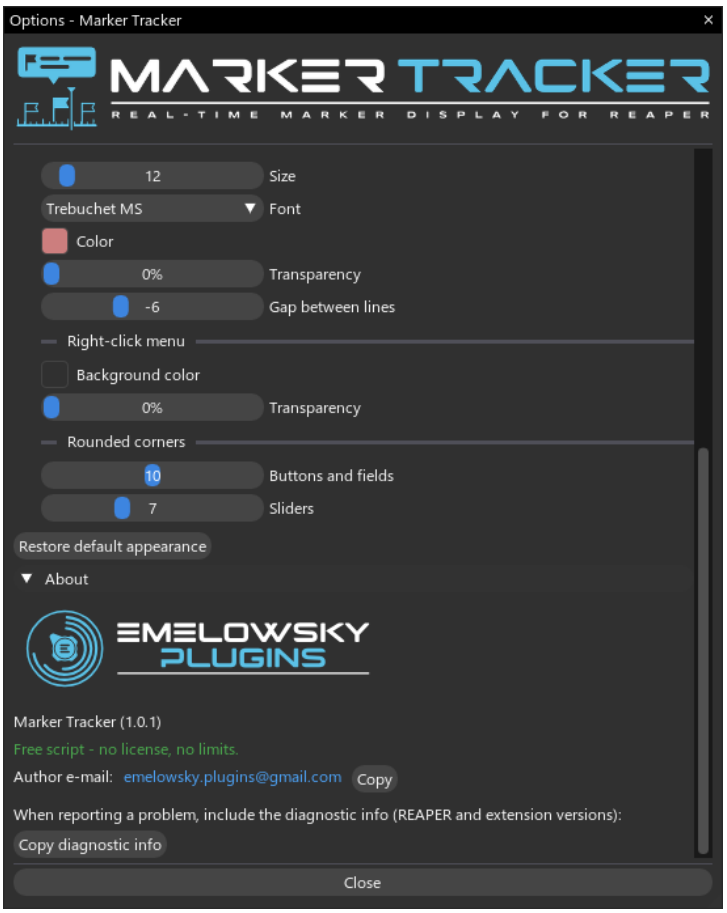


Fig. 9. The About section: version, author e-mail and diagnostic info.

The script version, a note that the script is free, the author's e-mail (**Copy** button) and the **Copy diagnostic info** button — it copies the REAPER, system, ReaImGui and js_ReaScriptAPI versions to the clipboard. Include them when you report a problem.

8. The “What's new” window

After the script is updated, the “What's new” window shows up once and lists the changes. Close it with **Close** or Esc.

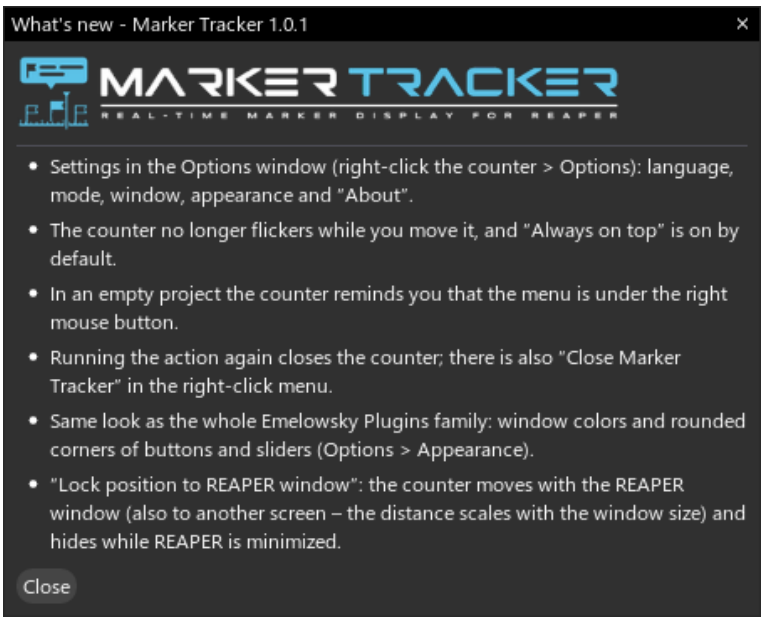


Fig. 10. The “What's new” window after the update to version 1.0.1.

9. Practical tips

- Name your markers after the parts of the song (Intro, Verse 1, Chorus…) — the counter tells you at once where you are.
- For live recording keep the counter large and high-contrast (Options → Appearance → Size, Color) — you can see it from across the room.
- Working on two monitors? Turn on “Lock position to REAPER window” — the counter moves together with REAPER.
- Regions instead of markers are handy when the project is split into songs or scenes.

10. Troubleshooting

Symptom / message	What to do
A message about missing ReaImGui at startup	Install ReaImGui with ReaPack (section 2.1) and restart REAPER.
The counter is not visible	Run the action again (it may have been turned off). If REAPER is minimized and the lock to the REAPER window is on, the counter comes back with the window.
The counter shows “0” and a hint	There are no markers in the project (or no regions in Regions mode). Add a marker: Insert → Marker (M).
The counter cannot be moved	A position lock is on — turn it off in the right-click menu.
“Lock position to REAPER window” is greyed out	Install js_ReaScriptAPI with ReaPack and restart REAPER.
The counter hides behind other windows	Turn on “Always on top”; it works more reliably with js_ReaScriptAPI.
Another error (a window with error text)	Take a screenshot of the whole error window and send it to emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com together with “Copy diagnostic info” (Options → About).

11. Contact and support

E-mail: **emelowsky.plugins@gmail.com**

All Emelowsky Plugins scripts: https://emelowsky.gumroad.com

Videos and tutorials: https://www.youtube.com/@EmelowskyPlugins

11.1 Version history

- **1.0.1** — Options in a separate window, 5 languages, lock to the REAPER window, the same look as the whole family (colors, rounded corners), flicker-free counter, hint in an empty project, “What's new” window, REAPER 6 version.
- **1.0** — first release.